

You need JavaScript enabled to use this service.

Cookies on Civil Service Jobs

We use some essential cookies to make this website work.

To understand how you use Civil Service Jobs and improve the website we'd like to set some additional cookies.

e94936c0e5a761224870f0e2d35654d3.178

Accept additional cookies

Reject additional cookies

1781762300-989cb8553b8a29f9ed8023254

change
Language
121
BQsDAAAABgoESm9icwAAAAIwYWdlY2xhc3M
1224
yes
1781762300-989cb8553b8a29f9ed8023254

Senior User Researcher (Research Operations Specialist) (Ref: 18782)

Ministry of Justice

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 28th June 2026

Ministry of
JUSTICE

Reference number

467087

Salary

£58,511 - £70,725

The national salary range is £58,511 - £65,329, London salary range is £63,343 - £70,725 Your salary will be dependent on your base location

National: £58,511 - £65,329
London: £63,343 - £70,725 (which may include an allowance up to £332)

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

Contents

Location

About the job

Benefits

Things you need to know

Apply and further information

Location

East Midlands (England), East of England, London (region), North East England, North West England, Scotland, South East England, South West England, Wales, West Midlands (England), Yorkshire and the Humber

About the job

Job summary

This position is based Nationally

Job description

Senior User Researcher (Research Operations Specialist)

Location: National*

Closing Date: 28th June

Interviews: W/C 13th July

Grade: 7

(MoJ candidates who are on a specialist grade, will be able to retain this grade on lateral transfer)

Salary**:

National: £58,511 - £65,329

London: £63,343 - £70,725 (which may include an allowance up to £332)

Working pattern: Full-time, Part-time, Flexible working

Contract Type: Permanent

Number of vacancies: 1

Vacancy number: 18782

***We offer a hybrid working model, allowing for a balance between remote work and time spent in your local office. Office locations can be found [ON THIS MAP](#)**

Please note that unless you are an existing member of staff at Justice Digital, Data and Science, the only London location being recruited to is 10 South Colonnade, E14 4PU. We are no longer recruiting to 102 Petty France, SW1H 9AJ.

The Role

Please note this role requires you to pass [Security Check](#) clearance. Please click on the [link](#) for details.

We're recruiting for a Senior User Researcher (Research Operations Specialist), here at [Justice Digital, Data and Science](#) to be part of our warm and collaborative User Research team.

This role aligns against Senior User Researcher from the Government Digital and Data Framework

User Researchers are key figures in the teams that design and deliver services. They help their teams develop a deep understanding of the people - citizens, businesses or government colleagues - who use our services. Their findings allow teams to design and build better services more quickly and at lower cost and risk, and to continuously improve services based on data and evidence.

As our services continue to grow in scale and complexity, Research Operations plays a critical role in enabling user researchers to deliver high quality insights safely, consistently and efficiently. By improving the systems, processes, tools and operational support around research, Research Operations helps increase the pace at which teams can learn about users and make informed decisions.

About the role

As a Research Operations Specialist, you will develop and continuously improve the operational support that enables our community of over 80 user researchers to work effectively in a large, agile and multidisciplinary organisation.

You will help ensure researchers have the recruitment services, participant management processes, tools, templates, operational guidance and

knowledge management support they need to generate high quality insights quickly, consistently and safely. You will also play a key role in maintaining the professional, ethical and legal standards expected of research at MoJ, while improving the efficiency, scalability and effectiveness of research operations across the organisation.

Your core accountabilities for the role will include:

- ensuring effective research governance, compliance and professional standards

- supporting researchers to deliver high quality research effectively and safely

- increasing the efficiency, scalability and pace of research delivery and insight generation

- supporting the development of the User Research community and profession across JDDS

We are looking for someone who is passionate about helping research teams work effectively at pace while maintaining high standards of quality, inclusion and compliance. You'll report to the Head of User Research, be part of the Research Leadership Team, and work closely with researchers across the organisation to identify operational challenges and opportunities for improvement.

You'll receive a range of excellent benefits when you join our department, including:

A generous employer pension contribution of 28.97% through the Civil Service Pension Scheme.

25 days of annual leave, (increasing to 30 days once you have reached 5 years of service), plus 8 bank holidays and a privilege day for the King's birthday.

Flexible working arrangements including hybrid working, working part time or compressed hours. Designed to support a positive work life balance.

Employees are allocated **10% of their working time for personal and professional development.**

A £1k per person learning budget is in place to support all our people, with access to best-in-class conferences and seminars, accreditation with

professional bodies, fully funded vocational programmes and e-learning platforms.

Compassionate maternity, adoption, and shared parental leave policies, with up to 26 weeks leave at full pay, 13 weeks with partial pay, and 13 weeks further leave. And maternity support/paternity leave at full pay for 2 weeks, too!

You can find more details of the Benefits we offer [here](#). To help picture your life at MoJ Justice Digital, Data and Science please take a look at our [blog](#).

Key Responsibilities:

Assure compliance by working with researchers and stakeholders to ensure research is carried out in line with appropriate legal, ethical and professional standards (including by not limited to inclusive research practices, GDPR and data handling, consent and confidentiality requirements, participant and researcher safeguarding, internal security clearance of tools, etc)

Lead on establishing and delivering operational services to the user research team, including participant recruitment and management, tools, templates, operational guidance, governance processes and supplier management

Identify operational bottlenecks, inefficiencies and duplication across the research process, and improve workflows and processes to increase the pace at which teams can generate and use research insights

Support the development of scalable and sustainable approaches to participant recruitment and management, including improving recruitment processes, supplier relationships and approaches to participant panels and ongoing recruitment needs

Improve operational maturity and efficiency through better tooling, automation and emerging technologies, including assessing the

opportunities and risks associated with AI-enabled research tools and processes

Maintain and deliver a strategy and roadmap for Research Operations, including clear priorities, measurable outcomes and an approach to continuous improvement

Support researchers to work confidently and effectively within agreed operational standards and processes by providing guidance, operational support, training and coaching where appropriate

Support the development of the User Research community and profession through initiatives such as onboarding, learning and development coordination, community management and sharing good practice

Work with a wide range of internal stakeholders and external suppliers to deliver effective operational services across the department

Take on additional research operations activities as the needs evolve

If this feels like an exciting challenge, something you are enthusiastic about, and want to join our team please read on and apply!

Person Specification

Essential

Research and Analysis Skills - including understanding methods, tools and operational needs of user researchers, giving you the ability to assess the appropriateness of various tools to meet those needs, including understanding the opportunities and risks associated with AI-enabled tools

User Centred and Agile Working - including understanding the demands this places on researchers, and the operational support needed to balance appropriate levels of governance, safeguarding, inclusion and compliance with ensuring delivery at pace

Continuous operational improvement skills - including the ability to identify operational problems and opportunities, and develop practical, proportionate solutions (in areas such as recruitment, governance,

tooling, insight sharing, etc) that improve the effectiveness of research operations and the pace of research delivery

Influencing skills including the organisational, influencing and stakeholder management skills needed to support the adoption of operational processes and services across teams

Contract and supplier management skills - including the ability to liaise with third party suppliers, build relationships and maintain a structured approach to managing recruitment, tools and operational services

Willingness to be assessed against the requirements for SC clearance

We welcome the unique contribution diverse applicants bring and do not discriminate based on culture, ethnicity, race, nationality or national origin, age, sex, gender identity or expression, religion or belief, disability status, sexual orientation, educational or social background or any other factor.

Our values are Purpose, Humanity Openness and Together. Find out more here about how we celebrate diversity and an inclusive culture in our workplace.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

Salary Information**

Base salary for this role is from National: £58,511 - £65,329 and London: £63,343 - £70,725

New entrants to the Civil Service joining the MoJ are expected to start at the minimum of the pay band.

Existing Civil Servants moving on a level transfer will retain their current base salary or move to the minimum of the pay band for the role, whichever is higher.

Existing Civil Servants who are promoted will either move to the bottom of the new grade's pay band or receive a 10% uplift, whichever provides the greater increase.

Candidates may also be eligible for a non-pensionable Government Digital & Data Allowance of up to £332 per year (London). This is a

temporary allowance, reviewed annually and may be retained, amended, or withdrawn.

The final offer will reflect the skills and experience you demonstrate during the assessment process.

Person specification

Please refer to Job Description

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £58,511, Ministry of Justice contributes £16,950 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\).](#)

Access to learning and development

A working environment that supports a range of flexible working options to enhance your work life balance

A working culture which encourages inclusion and diversity

A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Annual Leave

Public Holidays

Season Ticket Advance

For more information about the recruitment process, benefits and allowances and answers to general queries, please click the below link which will direct you to our Candidate Information Page.

Link: <https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ>

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

In Justice Digital, Data and Science, we recruit using a combination of the **Government Digital and Data Profession Capability** and **Success Profiles** Frameworks. We shall assess a combination of your Experience, Technical skills and Behaviours during the assessment process.

Stage 1 - Application and sift:

To apply for this position, you must submit the following as part of your application

A **CV** detailing your career history (including any relevant qualifications). Your CV will be assessed against the essential criteria outlined within the Person Specification of this advert.

A **Personal Statement** (no more than 750 words) which should outline your experience and skills, giving clear examples of work undertaken. It should specifically address the following 3 criteria listed below, using a separate paragraph for each.

Research and Analysis Skills - including understanding methods, tools and operational needs of user researchers, giving you the ability to assess the appropriateness of various tools to meet those needs, including understanding the opportunities and risks associated with AI-enabled tools

User Centred and Agile Working - including understanding the demands this places on researchers, and the operational support needed to balance

appropriate levels of governance, safeguarding, inclusion and compliance with ensuring delivery at pace

Influencing skills including the organisational, influencing and stakeholder management skills needed to support the adoption of operational processes and services across teams

A diverse sift panel will review the information in your CV and Personal Statement to assess the sift criteria specified above. We operate an anonymous shortlisting process. Please ensure your CV and Personal Statement do not include your name or any other identifying details.

Should we receive a high volume of applications, a pre-sift based on Research and Analysis Skills - including understanding methods, tools and operational needs of user researchers, giving you the ability to assess the appropriateness of various tools to meet those needs, including understanding the opportunities and risks associated with AI-enabled tools will be conducted before the sift.

Please access the following link for guidance on how to apply - [Application Guidance](#)

Stage 2 - Interviews:

Successful candidates who meet the required standard will then be invited to a panel interview held via Microsoft Teams. At interview stage, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements - Experience, Technical and the following Behaviours:

Delivery at pace

Changing and improving

Communicating and influencing

As part of your interview, you will be asked to deliver a presentation. Further details will be provided if successful at sift.

Appointments are made strictly in merit order. In the event that two or more candidates receive identical interview scores, the Delivery at Pace behaviour will be applied as the primary lead criterion to determine the final merit order.

Should you be unsuccessful in the role that you have applied for but demonstrate the capability for a role at a lower level, we reserve the right to discuss this opportunity with you and offer you the position without needing a further application.

A reserve list may be held for up to 12 months, from which further appointments may be made.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals

- nationals of the Republic of Ireland

- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	SSCL Recruitment Enquiries Team
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk
Telephone :	0345 241 5359

Recruitment team

Email : moj-recruitment-vetting-
enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel a department has breached the requirement of the Recruitment Principles and would like to raise this, please contact SSCL (Moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@gov.sscl.com) in the first instance. If the role has been advertised externally (outside of the Civil Service) and you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their web pages: <http://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/civil-service-recruitment/complaints/>

<https://www.jobtrain.co.uk/justicedigital/Job/JobDetail?jobid=1100>

